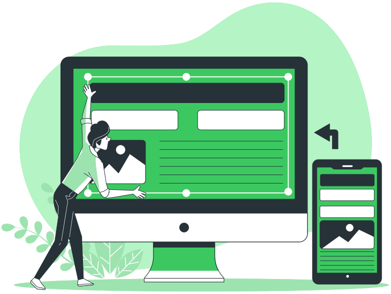
Mobile-First, Responsive Design



What we will learn today?

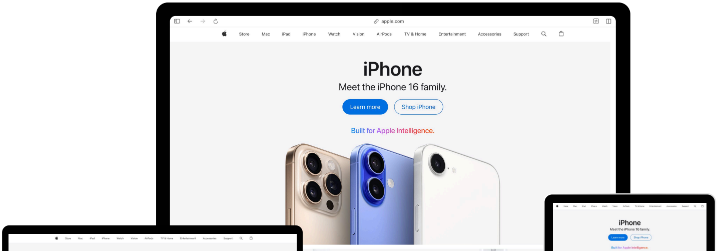
1. What is Responsive Design?
2. Why Responsive Design Matters
3. What is Mobile-First Design?
4. Tools & Techniques

What is Responsive Design?

What is Responsive Design?

A design that adjusts itself to look good and work well on all screen sizes — mobile, tablet, laptop, desktop.

It's NOT about making multiple separate designs — it's about one flexible design.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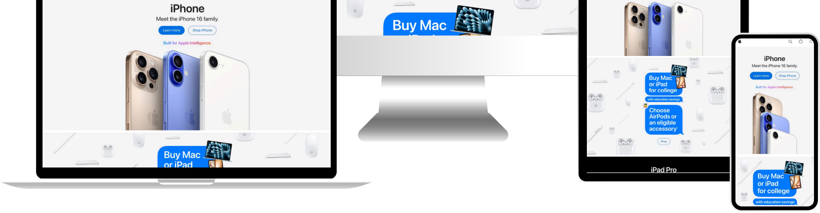

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Why Responsive Design Matters

Why Responsive Design Matters

- Over 70% of web traffic is from mobile devices.
- Saves time - no need to design everything from scratch.
- Gives users a good experience everywhere.
- Google ranks mobile-friendly sites higher (SEO advantage).

What is Mobile-First Design?

What is Mobile-First Design?

- You start your design for small screens (mobile) FIRST.
- Once the mobile version works, you expand to tablet and desktop.

Why?

- Mobile screens have less space — forces you to focus on what's really important.
- Prevents clutter.
- Easier to scale up than scale down.

Tools & Techniques

Tools & Techniques for Responsive Design

1. Layout Grids
2. Breakpoints
3. Figma Features for Responsive Design

Layout Grids

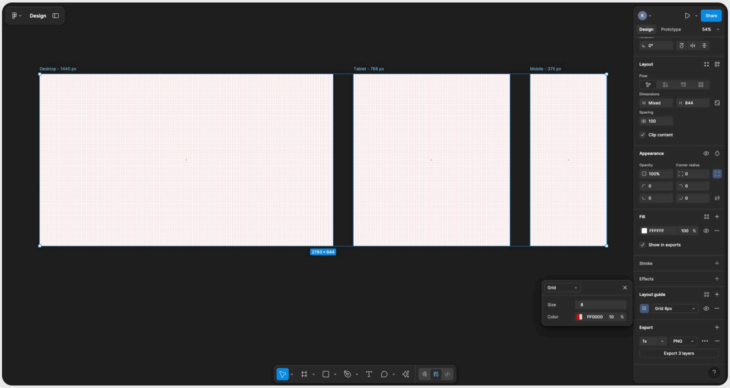
What is a Layout Grids?

- Grids help keep your design neat, organized, and consistent.
- They divide your screen into columns, making it easy to align text, images, and buttons.

Layout Guides in Figma

- Grid
- Column
- Rows

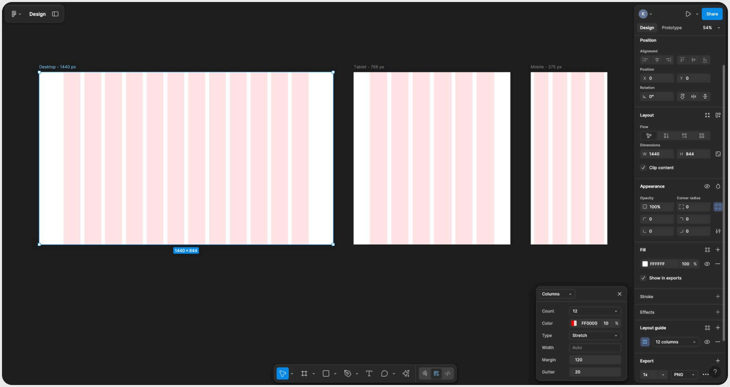
Grid


Design
Desktop - 1440 px
Tablet - 768 px
Mobile - 375 px
2783 × 844
Share
Design
Prototype
54%
Layout
Flow
Stroke
Effects
Export

Grid
Size 8
Color FF0000 10 %

Rotation 0°
Dimensions W Mixed H 844
Spacing 100
✓ Clip content
Appearance
Opacity 100%
Corner radius 0 0 0 0 0
Fill FFFFFF 100 %
✓ Show in exports
Layout guide Grid 8px
Export 1x PNG
Export 3 layers

Column


Design
Desktop - 1440 px
1440 × 844
Tablet - 768 px
Mobile - 375 px
Share
Design
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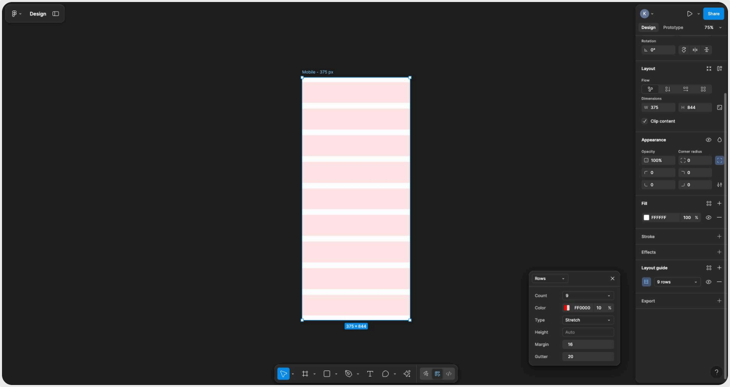
Position
Alignment
Position
X 0
Y 0
Rotation
0°
Layout
Flow
Dimensions
W 1440
H 844
Clip content
Appearance
Opacity
100%
Corner radius
0
Fill
FFFFFF
100 %
Show in exports
Stroke
Effects
Layout guide
12 columns
Export
1x
PNG

Columns

Count: 12
Color: FF0000 10 %
Type: Stretch
Width: Auto
Margin: 120
Gutter: 20

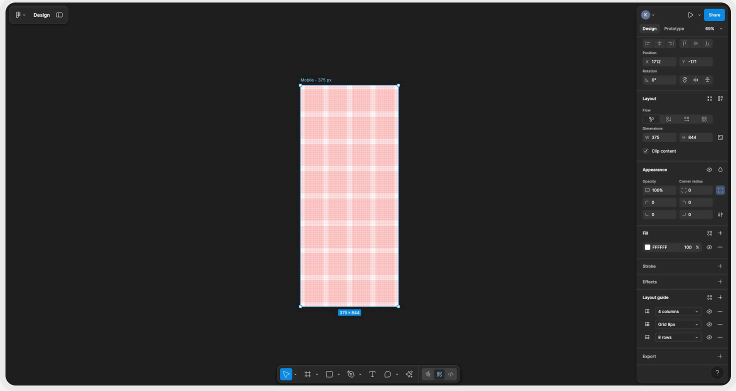
Rows


Design
Mobile - 375 px
375 × 844
Share
Design
Prototype
75%
Rotation
0°
Layout
Flow
Dimensions
W 375
H 844
Clip content
Appearance
Opacity
100%
Corner radius
0
Fill
FFFFFF
100 %
Stroke
Effects
Layout guide
9 rows
Export

Rows

Count: 9
Color: FF0000 10 %
Type: Stretch
Height: Auto
Margin: 16
Gutter: 20

Combined


Design
Mobile - 375 px
375 × 844
K
Share
Design
Prototype
69%

Position
X 1712
Y -171

Rotation
0°

Layout

Flow

Dimensions
W 375
H 844

☑ Clip content

Appearance

Opacity 100%
Corner radius 0
0
0
0
0

Fill
FFFFFF 100 %

Stroke

Effects

Layout guide
4 columns
Grid 8px
8 rows

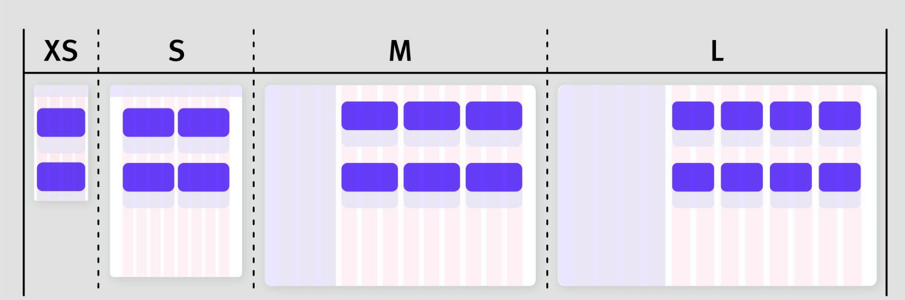
Export

Breakpoint

What is a Breakpoint?

- A Breakpoint is a specific screen width where your design layout needs to change to look good and work well.
- Breakpoints are points where your design adjusts to fit the screen - so everything stays clear and

easy to use.



Common Breakpoints

Device Type	Breakpoint (Approx.)
Mobile	320px – 480px
Tablet	600px – 768px
Small Desktop	1024px
Large Desktop	1440px and above

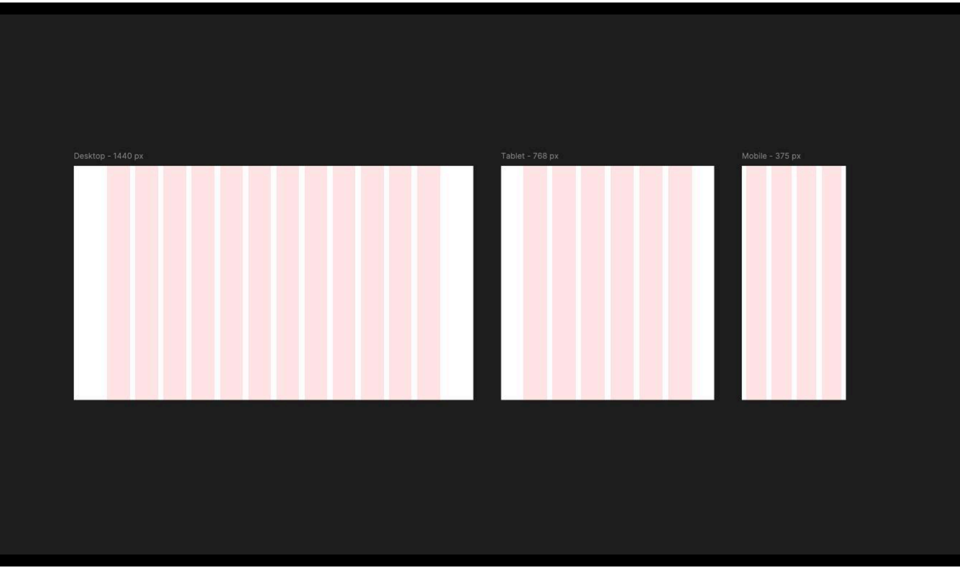
Figma Features for Responsive Design

Figma Features for Responsive Design

1. Frames
2. Constraints
3. Auto Layout

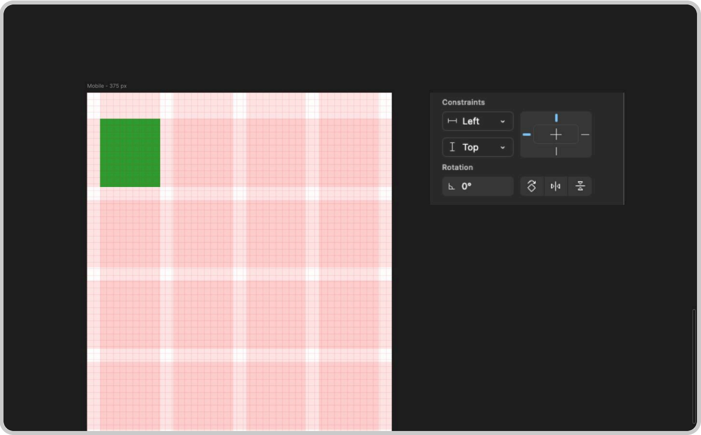
Frames

- In Figma, Frames act like the screen of a phone, tablet, or desktop.
- You create different Frames to see how your design looks on each device.


Desktop - 1440 px
Tablet - 768 px
Mobile - 375 px

Constraints

- Constraints tell Figma how your elements should behave when the Frame resizes.
- You can "pin" elements to the top, bottom, sides, or center.
- You can also set them to stretch, stay fixed, or move proportionally.



Mobile - 375 px

Constraints

Left

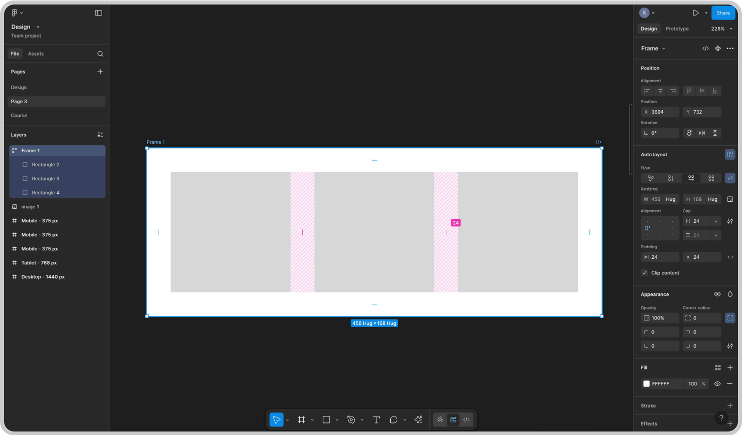
Top

Rotation

0°

Auto Layout

- Responsive by default – layouts adapt automatically to content changes
- Consistent spacing – padding and gaps stay uniform without manual adjustment
- Scalable components – components and variants resize cleanly across screens


Design
Team project
File
Assets
Pages
Design
Page 3
Course
Layers
Frame 1
Rectangle 2
Rectangle 3
Rectangle 4
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Mobile - 375 px
Mobile - 375 px
Mobile - 375 px
Tablet - 768 px
Desktop - 1440 px
Frame 1
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456 Hug × 168 Hug
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Share
Design
Prototype
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Frame

Position

Alignment

Position X 3694 Y 732

Rotation 0°

Auto layout

Flow

Resizing W 456 Hug H 168 Hug

Alignment

Gap 24 24

Padding 24 24

☑ Clip content

Appearance

Opacity 100%

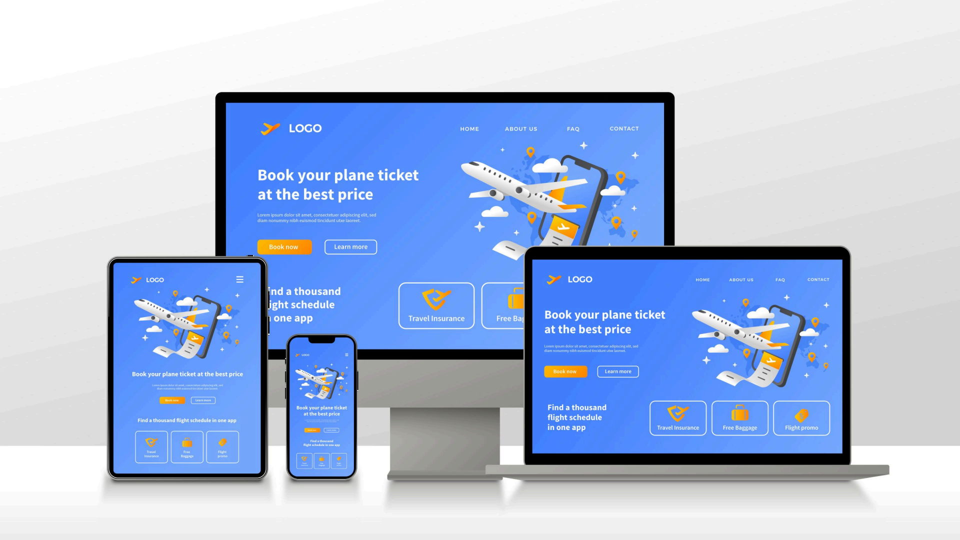
Corner radius 0 0 0 0

Fill

FFFFFF 100 %

Stroke

Effects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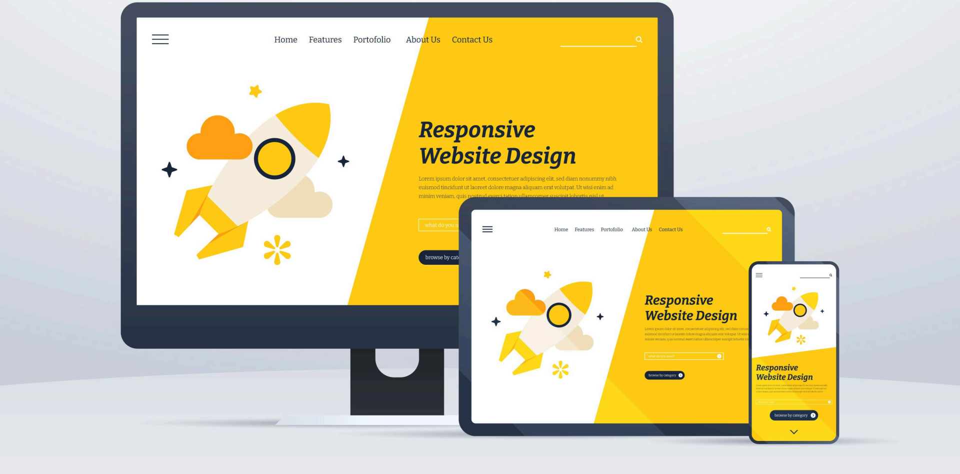
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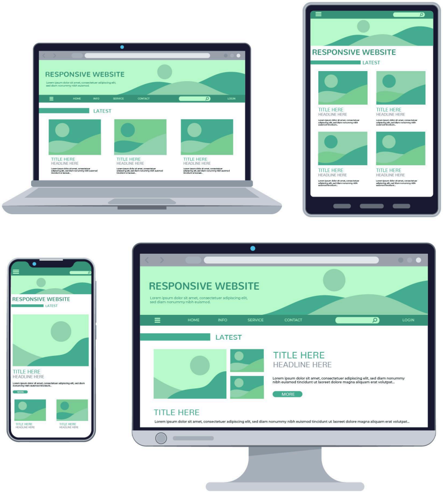
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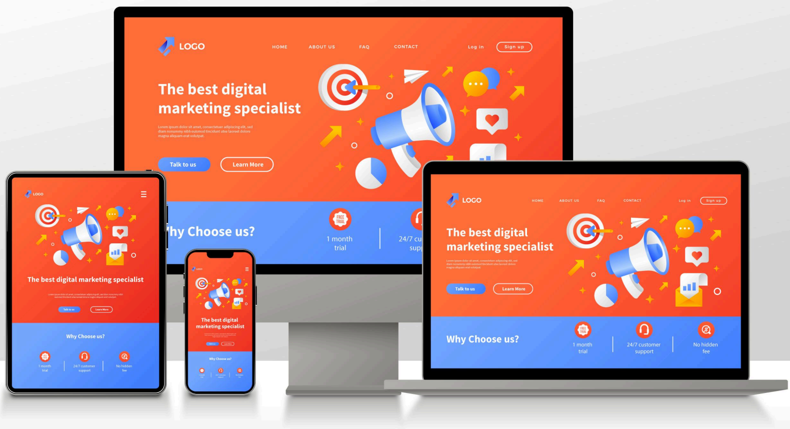
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